



ADVANCED PLANCHE

PRESS & PUSH-UPS

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■ Essentials

Hey! First, thank you for choosing my e-book. That is a great support for me.

In this e-book I will cover the most important information that every athlete aiming for advance level statics should know. I assume that you already have a stable planche (at least 5 seconds straddle planche), so you can focus on the next level stuff without distracting from the basics. Here I will touch all the problems that I have faced. After reading this book you will know how I train specifically for different planche skills and why it is so important to follow a strict routine.

Only doing attempts in your planche progress may work for beginner, but the more advanced you become, the more professional attitude to your training you should have. That will make your progress faster and will reduce the risk of injury.

Important! This is not a program that will show you exactly how many reps and how many sets you should do. The idea of this e-book is to let you know how I am currently training for maximum results. Everybody is different, so it is almost impossible to give a strict advance planche program that will work for everybody. Check what works for you and then apply it to your trainings.

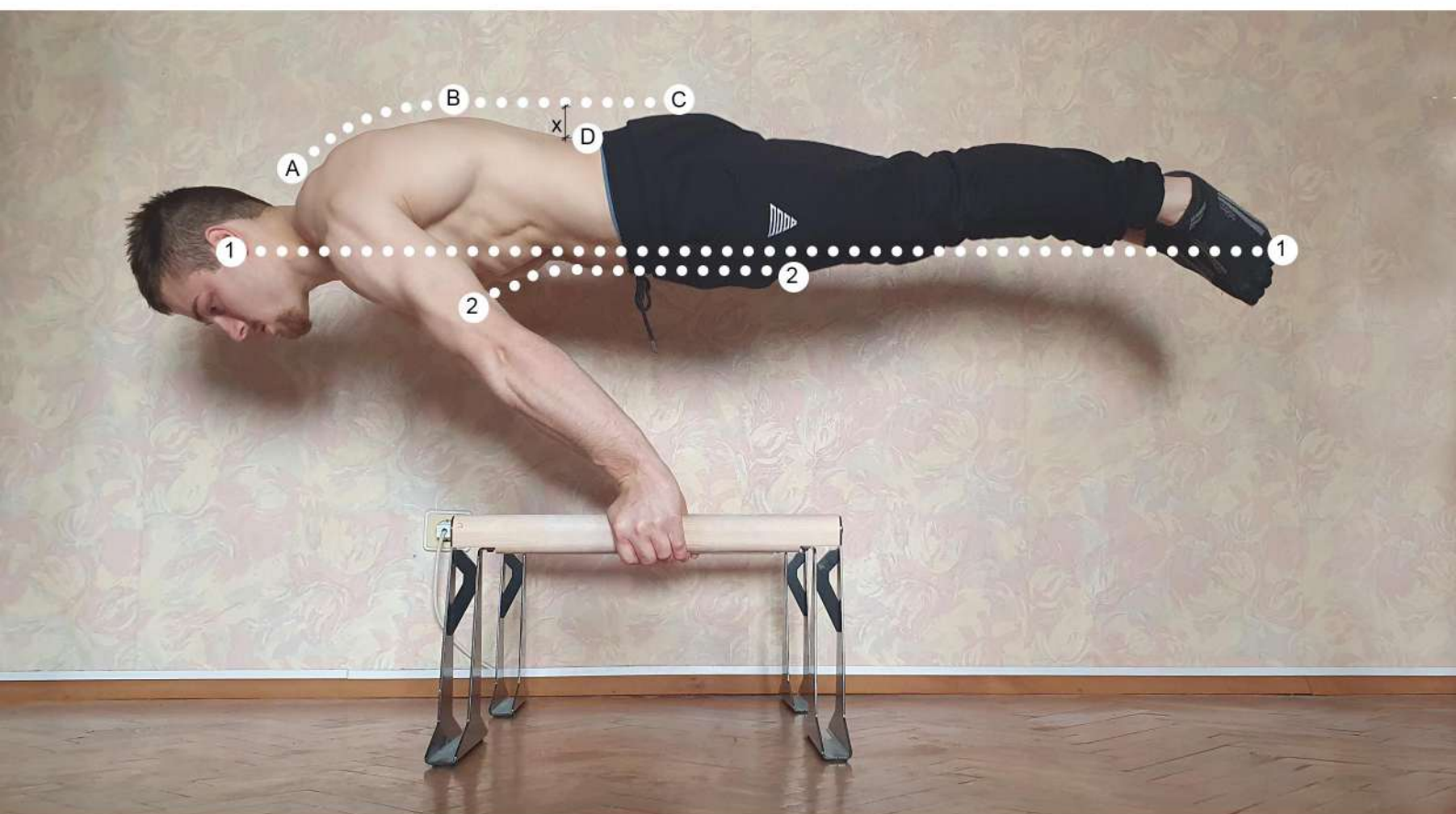
① Basic requirements

The focus on this e-book is planche push-ups and planche presses. You can start the program once you reach the minimum of 5 seconds perfect straddle planche hold. It is not wrong to do it earlier, but you will see that the progress will be much faster and natural when you have developed a stable initial strength.

② Proper planche technique

Having proper planche form is important requirement. That is why before moving the next level skills I want to be sure that you are aware of what a proper planche form is. The information of that paragraph is small part of the previous planche program for beginners.

All the photos are made with perpendicular faced to the body camera. That is the only angle where the form can be seen the best, without having any deviations.

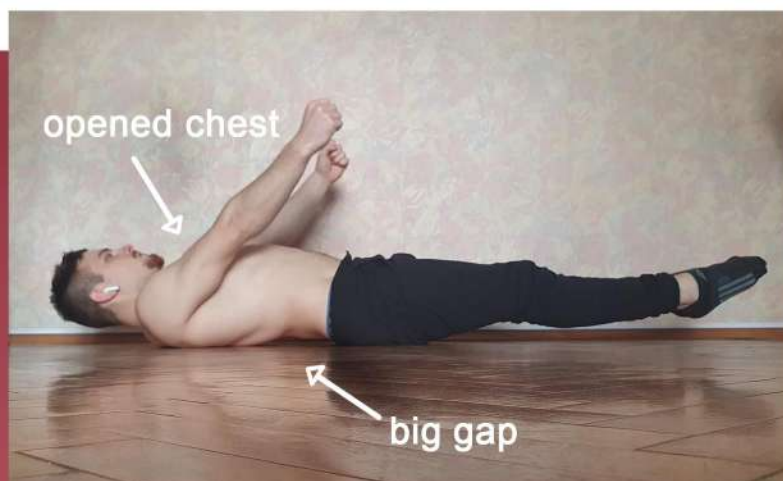


2.1. Hollow body.

What is the secret? The answer is simple. It is all about pushing the shoulders forward. Forget all the complex explanation for excessive hollow body, because most of the time that leads to over protraction, which makes the skill much easier.

As a result, you will achieve 3 things:

- The line A-B will be slightly curved.
- The shoulder should be on the line 1-1. This line must be around the level of the lower contour of the stomach or just a little bit above it
- The lower contour of the body between the stomach and the chest should follow line 2-2



Incorrect form

To feel and understand what I mean, lie down on the floor, raise the hands so that an angle Y is obtained, and then just push the shoulders forward. This will automatically hide the chest and will make that highly desired hollow body form without any excessive hollow body.



Proper form

2.2. Head.

Focus your gaze vertically down or even down the feet. Don't look forward. Looking forward will automatically open the chest and spoil the hollow.

2.3. The butt and the waist.

Many people do not activate that part. Often the butt goes way above the waist when an athlete does not squeeze it. In this case the waist will fall and will make the "banana" form of the planche. In this scenario the shoulder will take most of the tension, which is not recommended. Instead, try to tighten the butt and push it forward. By this way, the distance x (photo at page 3) will be smaller (the smaller, the better). Of course it's almost impossible the lower back to be on the same level as the butt unless you have really, really small butt :D

To feel it get the best out of it, lie down with your back facing the floor and try to tighten the butt. (photo at page 4) The idea is to reduce the gap between the waist and the floor. In the correct position, the waist should be as close as possible to the ground. To do almost straight line, think of point B to be on the level of point C. And point D to be as close as possible to the line BC by using the butt squeeze technique.

2.4. The hips

Although they are not that important for the planche, the hips are tightened during the planche performance. You can notice that the best after a heavy leg day, when you will have difficulty with the planche execution due to a problem with leg tightness.

2.5. The hamstring flexibility

Play a major role in the vision of the planche form. The better hamstring flexibility you have the more beautiful your planche will be. That is why for people with very poor flexibility, I suggest stretching before and after training.



2.6. Pointing the toes.

Few people pay attention to this. Pointing toes is widely considered to be something from the gymnastic and some people think it only contributes to creating better straight line. But in fact, there is something else. When pointing the toes, tightening the waist and butt becomes a bit harder compared to the exactly opposite 90 degrees toes. This is also the reason some calisthenics athletes when they are tired to end up their competition set use contra pointed toes. It often even becomes unconscious. The difference is small.



Pointed toes



Contra pointed toes

2.7. Elbows.

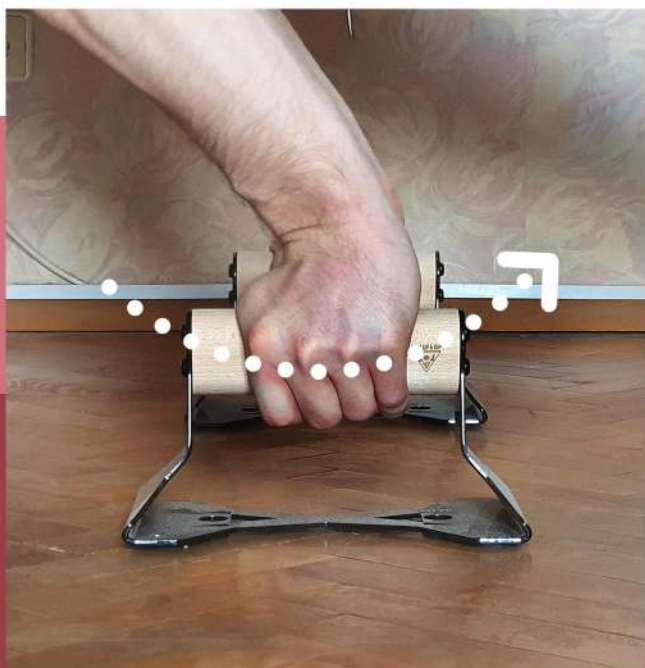
Should always be straight. Try to turn the elbows out. Flexibility is also very important for more beautiful performance. It usually gets better with practice. Now my elbows are overextended but 7 year ago they were less flexible.

2.8. Wrists.

There are big differences depending on which grip you use. I recommend every beginner to start with the easiest grip. For 70% of the people it is on parallel bars. Push the wrist to the direction shown in the photos. This will keep your shoulders and your planche high.



Turn the elbows out



Push on parallel bars



Push on floor

3 Planche push-ups vs planche press

Which one to start training first?

Which one is harder?

I will say that they both are different. However, if you already have a stable handstand, I recommend you start dealing first with planche press. The press is similar to the regular planche, because all the movement is executed with strength arms, unlike the planche push up, where you bend the elbows and it can be painful if you do it for the first time.

Since everyone is unique, we cannot say which one is harder. There are many people who have strong push-ups but still cannot do a single press. The opposite variant is also common. That is why I have separated both skills into 2 programs. They do not depend on each other and you can track your progress separately depending on your level, needs and interest.

■ Planche push-ups

Unlike the planche and the press, during the push-up the arms are bend. It is transition between planche and bent arm planche. Before ever trying planche push-ups i was able to hold straddle planche for at least 5 seconds and i was doing 20+ handstand push-ups. Of course that is not an obligational level, but I mention it just as reference.

① Proper push-ups technique 3 4

I will share my point of view of how the planche push-up must be performed.

I will separate the movement by 3 positions - A, B, C.

A true push up must contain all the 3 positions

1.1. Position A. Full planche position.

Always performed with hollow body (as I explained in the previous chapter). Start and finish the movement at that position. Keep the hollow after the push-up.



1.2. Position B. 45-degree bend arm position

Bend the arms and open them a little bit aside from the body. Try not to touch the chest with the arms, because that is considered as a lock and it is not a clean move anymore (photo at page 11) Keep the hollow body but prepare to bring the chest and the shoulders to natural position while you go to position C.



1.3. Position C. Bottom position

Put the chest and the shoulders in natural position. Keep the chest a millimeter from the ground and do not open it too much. Opening the chest and over retracting the shoulders will make the movement unnecessary harder, because you will need more strength to return to hollow body position. It will also lead to “banana” form of the push-up and planche.





Locked position



Proper position

Which grip is the best to start with?

Start with the easiest for you. For 90% of the athletes is on parallettes

Keep in mind that this is my personal point of view. There is nowhere written any definition or law of how this movement must be done. This skill does not exist in the gymnastics. Every athlete performs it by different way and has his own opinion. When I mean proper technique, I consider the hardest and the most beautiful performance.

2 Easier variations

2.1. Push-ups with hollow body. 5 6

Some athletes tend to keep over protracted hollow body during all the push up. I do not say its incorrect but most of the times that ruins the beauty of the horizontal line and its easier since you do not have to make any transition between natural position and hollow body.



Over protracted hollow



Over protracted hollow in position C

2.2. Half push-ups. 7 8

You can see many athletes also doing half push-ups (transition from A to B). Obviously the difference is huge.

2.3. Fast push-ups. 9 10

Other athletes use momentum and speed to make higher number. The lack of needed strength and quality of the push-up is apparent.

Even though the above-mentioned variations are easier compared to proper technique, they all are good for beginners. That is why you will see them included in the program below. For example, a beginner can try going to position C without losing the hollow body, because it will be easier and he will feel the move. The transition from natural positions to hollow body may be dangerous if you do not have the initial preparation.

3 Way of training

3.1. How often to train push-ups and how to combine with other trainings?

I recommend to those who have just started the push-ups to add 1 additional day specifically for that skill. Do not combine it with planche hold or form training, because that will reduce your efficiency.

7 days cycle

You can train push-ups once a week, since the push up workout is not the only planche training you do during the week. A good option is to do it on a fresh day, I usually put one day rest between planche hold training and push up training. A reasonable sequence, which represents my way of training is:

Planche hold - planche form - rest/other skills - planche push-ups - rest/other skills - planche press - rest/other skills

Table for better understanding:

Day 1. Form	Day 2. Hold	Day 3. Rest/other skills	Day 4. Push-up	Day 5. Rest/other skills	Day 6. Press	Day 7. Rest/other skills
1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base	1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base		1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base		1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base	

Other possible structures without including press training:

4 days cycle

Form – hold – rest/other skills – push-upS – rest/other skills

5 days cycles

Form – hold – rest/other skills – push-ups – rest/other skills - rest/other skills

Form – hold – rest/other skills - rest/other skills – push-ups – rest/other skills

In the previous e-book I have covered everything about the training for hold and form (from specific warm up to all the basic exercises I do) I assume that you already have a good level at planche, and you have your own way of training for that. I divide my planche training by hold and form just because that the only way for me to keep them both on a high level.

3.2 A deep look into the planche push-ups day

As you can see in the chart (page 13), I have divided the training into 4 parts: normal warm up, planche warm up, attempts and base workout for planche push-ups.

3.2.1. Normal warm up.

You already have a good planche and train probably for more than 1-2 years. Do the warm up you always do and the one you feel that works the best for you.

3.2.2. Planche warm up.

I often see guys with a high planche level not doing planche warm up and even skipping normal warm up. That works for a few years in a long term the injury is inevitable. That is why aside from the regular warm up do also a specific planche warm up. I will make a fast summary from the last e-book about that topic.

The main idea is to simulate the exercise, to feel the same type pressure but lighter. In this way, the risk of injury is highly reduced, because the muscles and tendons will be prepared for the planche tension. I also want to note that the quality of exercise will be greater after the specific warm-up. I always have slight pain before warming up and it is quite painful for the shoulders and elbows to perform any complicated exercise without planche warm up.

It is important to keep warming up till this pain is gone. Better hear the crackling, creaking of your arms and shoulders during that warm up, rather than during the real attempts. Usually 10-15 minutes are enough.

About sets and reps. Do that much as it will not exhaust you for the attempts.

Exercises I do for planche warm up:



Bottom position



Leaned position

Leaned push-ups. 11

Execute the leaned push-up with the upper shown technique. This is probably the most important warm up for the planche push-up, because unlike the planche in the push-up there is different pressure, because the arm is bent. 3-4 sets per 4-5 reps can be enough.



Retracted position



Protracted position

Shoulder push-ups. 12

Transition between a retracted and a protracted position. Think about how you open and close the chest while pushing with the shoulders. Do not bend the elbows. I recommend no more than 10-15 reps in a single try. No need to get exhausted from the beginning.

Rubber band pulling. 13

Using the shoulder forward technique. Get a lightweight rubber band that will allow you to do 10 reps in a single try without exhausting you.



Planche leans. 14

Again with the planche technique, try to push the shoulders forward and lean them as much as possible, while your feet stand on the ground. Be careful not to overdo the hollow body, no need for that in the planche leans. I usually do 4-5 attempts.



Proper lean



Incorrect lean

3.2.3. Attempts.

This part is different for each level. I have divided the progressions into 6 different levels:

Levels 1, 2 and 3 are concerning straddle planche push-ups.

Levels 4, 5, 6 are about full planche push-ups. They follow the same model as the first 3 levels

Requirements.

I recommend meeting all the requirements before starting a level.

For example:

If you meet the planche push-ups requirements but you do not meet the planche hold requirements, then you need to work on your full planche hold before starting the level.

If you meet the planche hold requirements, but you do not meet the planche push-up requirements, go to the previous levels and work on your straddle push-ups before starting the level.

Note: a clean rep should be executed with normal speed. The end of the movement must be position A (photo on page 9)  3  4

How many attempts?

Do the attempts till you cannot perform the skill properly anymore and never less than 3 attempts. As you can see, I have put the hardest skill (the aim for a certain level) at the first place. You should make at least 3 attempts of it, whatever the form is. The idea is to start feeling this exercise. Once you do those 3 attempts move forward to the second exercise. Do it till you cannot perform it anymore and again minimum 3 attempts before moving to the third. The same principal for the fourth.

3.2.4 Base

Always do in the end of the training.

Sets and reps.

The exercises are suitable for all the levels. The variations of levels can be unlimited because people are different. That is why it will be almost impossible to be accurate in level division. The number of the reps should be a percentage of the maximum that a person can do. For example if you can do maximum 10 pull-ups then go for 3 sets per 8 pull-ups

There are usually two types of weakness for the planche push-ups:

Hardly going back to position A (not being able to return to hollow body position)

Hardly pushing from position C (problem in the bottom of the movement)

Those two weaknesses lead to dividing the base into two parts:

Exercises for the upper movement:

Half push-ups with rubber band (A to B to A). 15

The aim is to concentrate only on getting back to high full planche, without losing energy for the whole move. Follow the 80 % rule but it is more important to focus on the proper performance.



Dumbbell hold 16

Get two dumbbells or other weights (each 5-10 kg, no need for more) Hold on a proper planche position while lying on the ground. Try to keep the angle x the same all the time.

Exercises for the upper movement:

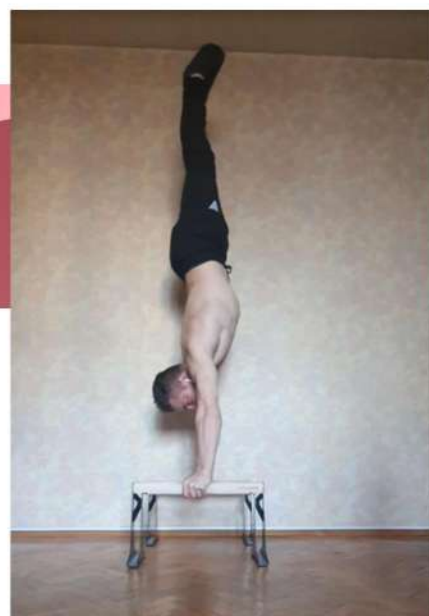
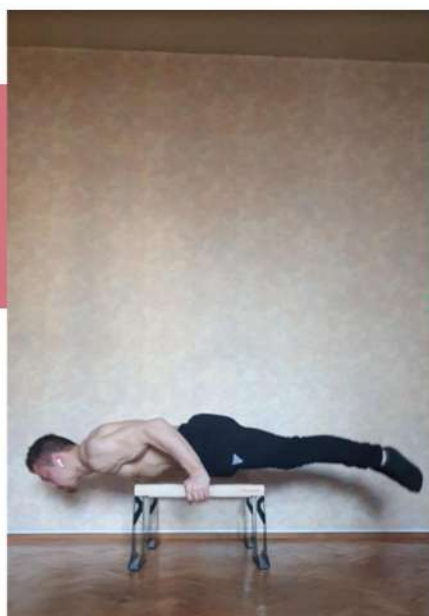
Negatives + leaned push up 17

Do transition from position A go to position B with a normal speed and from position B to position C go slower. Then do a normal leaned push-ups to planche lean and repeat.

Fast push-ups 9 10

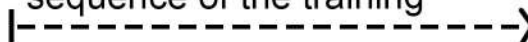
Even though fast push-ups with a kick are considered as cheat on competitions, they are super good for increasing the endurance and making the transition between position C and position B easier. They are significantly easier than the clean push-ups, that is why I put it in the base part. The exercise can be performed in straddle or full position, depending on your level.

90-degree push-ups 18 19



4 Program

sequence of the training



Lvl	Requirement	Goal	Attempts
1	-1 clean rep of negative straddle push-up (from A slowly to C.) 20 -At least 5 seconds straddle planche	Half straddle push-up (A to B to A)	1. Half straddle push-ups (A to B to A) Minimum 3 attempts 2. Negatives on straddle (A to C) – till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts
2	-1 clean rep of half straddle push-up (A to B to A) -At least 8 seconds straddle planche	Straddle push-up (with hollow body) (A to C to A).	1. Straddle push-up with hollow body (A to C to A) Minimum 3 attempts 2. Half straddle push-ups (A to B to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 3. Negatives on straddle. (A to C) Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts
3	-1 clean rep of straddle push-up (with hollow body) (A to C to A). -At least 8 seconds straddle planche	Clean straddle push-up (A to C to A)	1. Clean straddle push up (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 2. Straddle push-up with (hollow body) (A to C to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 3. Half straddle push-ups (A to B to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 4. Negatives on full. (A to C) Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts
4	-Clean rep of negative full push-up (from A slowly to C.) 21 -2 clean straddle planche push up (A to C to A) -At least 8 seconds clean full planche	Half full push-up (A to B to A)	1. Half full push-ups. (A to B to A) Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 2. Clean straddle push-up (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 3. Straddle push-up (with hollow body) (A to C to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 4. Half straddle push-ups (A to B to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 5. Negatives on full. (A to C) Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts
5	-1 clean rep of half full push-up (A to B to A) -2 clean straddle planche push up (A to C to A) 22 -At least 8 seconds clean full planche	Full push-up (with hollow body) (A to C to A)	1. Full push up (with hollow body) (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 2. Half full push-ups. (A to B to A) Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 3. Clean straddle push-up (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 4. Straddle push-up (with hollow body) (A to C to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 5. Negatives on full. (A to C). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts
6	-1 clean rep of full push-up (with hollow body) (A to C to A). -2 clean straddle planche push up (A to C to A) -At least 8 seconds clean full planche	Clean full push-up (A to C to A)	1. Clean full push up (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 2. Full push up (with hollow body) (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 3. Half full push-ups. (A to B to A). Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts 4. Clean straddle push-up (A to C to A). Minimum 3 attempts 5. Negatives on full. Till you cannot perform them anymore and minimum 3 attempts

Warm up
Planche warm up

Planche base

Usually the requirements for a level is the goal for the previous level.

As I mentioned, the base training is not connected to any level.
Usual base that I do:

Exercise	Sets/ reps
Half push-ups with rubber band (A to B to A).	3 x n (80 percent of your max), but it is more important to focus on the proper performance
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Negatives + leaned push up	3 x n (80 percent of your max)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Dumbbell hold	3 x n (80 percent of your max) (5-10kg)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
90-degree push ups	3 x n (80 percent of your max)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Fast push-ups	3 x n (80 percent of your max)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	

Between the planche push-up exercises I usually do others for pull strength (like base for front lever or hefesto) By this way I am resting from the push while I am doing the pull. It is faster and more efficient training. Since the front lever and hefesto are not a subject to this program I will not focus on them.

Planche press

1 Proper planche press technique 23 24

When the planche press is performed correctly the most involved body part are the shoulders. They are the most vulnerable of injury and pain.

To understand perfectly the technique, I will give an example with one of the exercises that I recommend as a base workout. Get some weights (5-10kg) and face your back to a wall. Bring the shoulders forward and lift the weights till you reach a handstand position. During all the movement try not losing the hollow body.

 33  34



The feeling of doing the real planche press is absolutely the same. All the body must freeze. As you can see, everything goes to the shoulder causing shoulder pain to many athletes. That is why I recommend having a stable planche and shoulder strength before dealing with presses. For a straight press always keeps your glaze looking down. If you look forward that will open your chest and you will automatically make a “banana” form press.  25  26



About the grip.

Start with the favorite and the easiest for you. There are differences between each grip. Most of the time the easiest grip is on parallels, followed by ground (45 degrees palm). All supine grips are significantly harder, and people tend to do more "banana" form presses rather than straight. The good thing is that you can implement supine grips on the base exercises (especially ex. 4 from the planche presses base)

Since the pressure in the shoulder is big, I recommend to those who do presses for the first time, instead of proper planche press to do "banana" form planche press. Will cover it in a while.

Flexibility

In order to keep the body straight during from the planche till the handstand you need to have a perfect handstand and for that a good shoulder flexibility is a must. Most of the people who are good in planche do not have perfect form of the handstand, because of the bad shoulder flexibility. If your shoulders strength is good, but flexibility is really bad that means that you will do the first 70 percents of the press, but the next 30 percent you won't remain in the same hollow body position and you will open the chest. The more flexible you are the less percent will remain till the perfect handstand.



Proper press



Flexibility limit

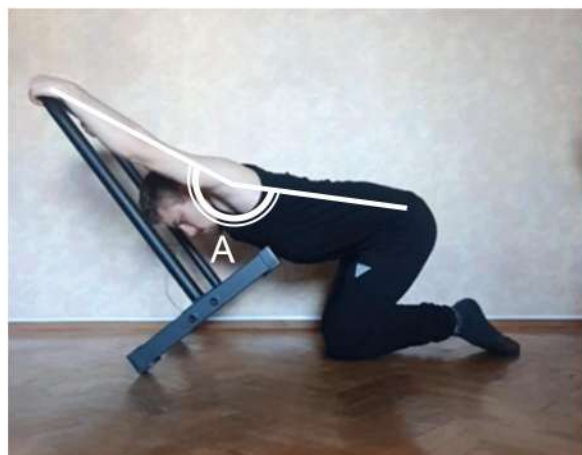


Compensations

The solution is simple, all come from the angle A. The wider it is, the better your press will be.

Bad shoulder flexibility was one of my biggest problems in 2015. Since I was training strength for almost 3 years my flexibility on the shoulders was just terrible and I had to implement some stretching in my training program.

So work on that flexibility in the end of your trainings. It will pay off in a long term.



2 "Banana" form planche press

Nothing that much to say here. It is really similar to the proper press but here you start lifting your legs first and then push with the shoulders. By this way, the pressure on your shoulder and the risk of injury will be reduced.



Most of the people find it as a mistake, but in my opinion, it is only a mistake done on a competition. This press is part of the process. I have been doing it since 2014. At that time I had no idea of what a correct planche means. I just look at it like transition from planche to handstand. Since 2014 I have been doing only banana press, which gave me lot of strength and endurance.

This press protected me from putting too much stress on my shoulders. You can see that even at my record of 17 planche presses. For sure if I did only clean reps the number would be significantly smaller.

3 Way of training

3.1. How often to train press and how to combine with other trainings?

The approach is really similar to the planche push-up training. I recommend planning one day during the week specifically dedicated to the press.

7 days cycle

An example of planche routine can be:

Planche form - planche hold - rest/ other skills - planche push up - rest/other skills - planche press - rest/ other skills

Chart for better understanding.

Day 1 - form	Day 2 - hold	Day 3 – rest/other skills	Day 4 – push-up	Day 5 – rest/other skills	Day 6 - press	Day 7 – rest/other skills
1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base	1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base		1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base		1.warm up 2.planche warm up 3.attempts 4.base	

If you consider not training push-ups, there are also other optional variants:

4 days cycle

Form – hold – rest – press – rest

5 days cycle

Form – hold – rest – press – rest – rest

Form – hold – rest – rest – press – rest

3.2.A deep look into the planche press day

The main structure of the planche push up-day remains the same as the others, but it is more important what to do in the “attempts” and “base” part.

3.2.1. Normal warm up

3.2.2. Specific planche warm up.

Already covered in the push-ups chapter. For planche press you do not need leaned push-ups warm up.

3.2.3. Attempts

There are 6 distinct levels.

Level 1,2 and 3 devoted to the straddle planche press

Level 3,4,5 devoted to the full planche press.

The idea of all the levels is to slowly increase the strength for a smoother progression and lower the risk of injuries.

I recommend meeting all the requirements before starting a level.

How many sets and reps?

Do the attempts till you can't perform the skill properly anymore. And never less than 3 attempts

All the levels are included in the chart of the program on page 33.

• Level 1

Requirements:

Minimum 5 sec. of straddle planche stable hold 2

This is for total beginners who have never ever done press. The main goal is a single straddle planche press (“banana” form). Keep in mind all the techniques I explained at chapter “proper planche press” and implement it in your attempts.

Goal:

1 straddle press (“banana” form) 26

Handstand to straddle planche 8 seconds hold 28

For those who struggle hard even with a single attempt of a press, better skip the press and concentrate on “handstand to straddle planche” and the base part. That will give you the initial strength. You can be strong in a planche but still weak in the press because they both are different with different type of push. Having a strong planche does not reassures you also have a strength for press.

• Level 2**Requirements:**

- At least 1 straddle press ("banana" form)  26
- Handstand to minimum 8 sec straddle planche hold  28

Goals:

- 2-3 straddle press ("banana" form)

The goal is to execute 2-3 straddle presses ("banana" form) Do not get obsessed from perfect execution. Only think about not bending the arms and not overexposing the "banana" form.

• Level 3**Requirements:**

- 2-3 straddle planche presses ("banana" form)
- Minimum 10 sec straddle planche stable hold  2

Goal:

- 2 clean straddle presses  29
- 5+ straddle presses ("banana form")

Since you already have the initial strength, now it is time to work on form and hold as a different subjects. That is the way that helped me having proper form and great endurance at the same time.

For the quality.

The first attempts will be devoted to the quality performance. Think only about the perfect line of the body during the press, freeze the body and work only with the shoulders. I do not recommend going hard for those sets, because you need to save energy for the next part. Look at that first part as training for your brain and creating better feeling of the form.

For quantity.

Do not think about the form but try to do as many as you can. Do 3/4 sets with 80 percent of your max. For instance, if you can do maximum 10 banana planche presses go for 4 sets per 8 presses. In each training try to make more presses than the previous training.

It is possible not to put the training for quality and quantity in one training. You can separate it by two days. I have tried that way and I do not think this works for me, because by this way there are too many planche days, and there is no time for the other skills and rest. That is why in this program I have put all the planche press in one training.

• Level 4**Requirements:**

- 2 clean straddle press  29
- 5 sec full planche  1

If you have full planche but you cannot do 2 clean straddle press, then go to previous level and improve the presses

If you have 2-3 clean straddle but you cannot do full planche this means that you must improve your full planche.

There is no connection between straddle planche presses and full planche. In 2014 I have been doing 6-7 straddle presses without being able to full planche, while there were other athletes who were full planching better than me and still not having a single straddle press.

Goal:

- A single full press ("banana" form)  25
- Handstand to full planche 8 seconds hold  27

At this level it is really important to continue training your straddle planche press (quality and quantity)

Sequence of the training:

- Full planche press ("banana" form)
- Handstand to full planche hold
- Straddle planche press – quality (straight form)
- Straddle planche press – quantity ("banana" form)

• Level 5**Requirements:**

- A single full press ("banana" form)  25
- Handstand to minimum 8 sec of full planche hold  27
- Same model of training as level 4.

Goal:

- 2-3 full planche presses ("banana" form)

Sequence of the training:

- Full planche press ("banana" form)
- Straddle planche press – quality (straight form)
- Straddle planche press – quantity ("banana" form)

• Level 6**Requirements:**

- 2-3 full planche presses (“banana” form)
- 10 sec full planche  1

Goal: Your limit

Since you are already strong you can concentrate only on full planche presses

Sequence of the training:

- Full planche press – quality (“straight” form)
- Full planche press – quantity (“banana” form)

Test your limits.

From time to time you can have a training when you will concentrate only on the quantity and you can try your real max repetitions of “banana” form planche presses and see how you progress. Also, you can test sometimes your max of straight planche presses.

3.2.4 Specific planche base for press.

Always in the end of the training

The exercises are suitable for all the levels and I have not put any level division or number of sets and reps. The rule you can follow is again 80% of your maximum hold/reps

Exercises for endurance and power:

Press with a help of a friend.

Only for beginner. Tell your buddy not to pull you back when you are on a planche, but to put you on a natural lean position. It is perfect for beginner level, because there is somebody who can control exactly how much to support you.

Full planche press from dip position with a little kick/swing. 30

Maybe the exercise that helped me the most as a beginner. It gave me the confidence that I can do press when I was not strong enough for it. It is all because I used a little swing to help go through the press. Even today I do it in the end of my training base because it gives me endurance.

An old video of me from 2014 where I was doing that press.

If you can do maximum 10, go for 3 sets per 8 reps. If you can do max 5, then go for 3 sets per 4 reps. If you can do max 2, then do 3 sets per 1 rep. The more you get tired, the more swing you will use.

For the total beginners it can also be executed in a straddle position.



The following 2 exercises are more about the quality of the press. You can do both with a proper straight form:

Negatives. 31 32

From perfect handstand go slowly to full planche without holding it in the end. The slower the better. During all movement try keeping you whole body straight. This base will give you the needed feeling of the correct planche press.

Better concentrate on the quality of a single attempts rather than doing lot of attempts

Weightlifting. 33 34

The grip depends on the weights you use. You can do it with a plate, but a better choice will be to use rings with attached weights to them. That is something I do right now. I prefer that way because it imitates the real planche press on parallels/rings and it gives a certain flexibility for the grip choice. While using a plate is a bit different.



Warning! Go for weights that allow you to make more than 15 reps on a fresh in a single set. Usually around 7-15 kg is enough. Using too much weight can injure your shoulder. I have done that before and it brings me out from the planche game for a while, causing me shoulder tendonitis.

Additional base exercises. Those exercise have presence also on the previous e-book. That base is more about overall planche strength rather than press strength:

Dumbbells hold.

Lie down on the floor on your back and take 2 dumbbells or other type of weights. Get to the position of the full planche (position B) Do not forget to push the shoulders forward, to tighten the butt and concentrate the gaze at your feet. For maximum result better make the angle x a bit smaller than it must be. Lately I use 7.5 kg at each hand, but if you are a beginner go for 5kg. I do not recommend more than 15 kg. Better focus on a longer hold in the right position.

Dumbbell press. 16

A transition from position A to position B. Do not go wide but keep hands close to the body (shoulder distance) That's because maltese (wide planche) and full planche are different exercises and muscles work different way. Better go for lighter kg, no more than 7 kg and do it slowly with control.



Position A



Position B



Position A



Position B

4 Program

To simplify everything I have made a chart. To simplify everything I have made a chart.

sequence of the training
|----->

Lvl	Requirements	Goal	Warm up	Attempts training	Planche base
1	-Minimum 5 sec straddle planche stable hold	-1 straddle press ("banana" form) -Handstand to 8 seconds straddle planche hold	Warm up Planche warm up	-Straddle press with a kick or Straddle press ("banana" form)  35 -Handstand to straddle planche	Planche base
2	-At least 1 straddle press ("banana" form) -Handstand to minimum 8 sec straddle planche hold	-2-3 straddle press ("banana" form)		-Multiple (2-3) straddle press ("banana" form) -Single straddle press ("banana" form)	
3	-2-3 straddle planche presses ("banana" form) -Minimum 10 sec straddle planche stable hold	-2 clean straddle presses -5+ straddle presses ("banana form")		-Training for quality (Straddle press) (straight form) -Training for quantity (Straddle press) ("banana form")	
4	-2 clean straddle press -5 sec full planche	-A single full press ("banana" form) -Handstand to 8 seconds full planche hold		-Full press ("banana" form) - HS to full planche -Training for quality (Straddle press) (straight form) -Training for quantity (Straddle press) ("banana form")	
5	-A single full press ("banana" form) -Handstand to minimum 8 sec full planche	-2-3 full planche presses ("banana" form)		-Multiple full press (2-3) ("banana" form) -Training for quality (Straddle press) (straight form) -Training for quantity (Straddle press) ("banana form")	
6	-2-3 full planche presses ("banana" form) Minimum 10 sec full planche stable hold	-You limit		-Training for quality (full press) (straight form) -Training for quantity (full press) ("banana form")	

My usual base training for presses:

Exercise	Sets/reps
Full planche press from dip position with a little kick/swing	3 x n (80 percent of your max)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Negative press	3 x n (80 percent of your max)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Weightlifting	3 x n (80 percent of your max) (5-10kg)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Dumbbell hold	3 x n (80 percent of your max) (5-10kg)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	
Dumbbell press	3 x n (80 percent of your max) (5-10kg)
Front lever exercise/hefesto exercise	

The approach is similar to the push-up base. I usually combine it with other base exercises like levers or hefesto.

■ Most common questions

I give a fast answers to the most common questions.

From what level should I start?

For the attempts part. Look at the requirements for each level. If you cannot meet the requirements for a certain level, then work on the previous one till you meet them.

For the base part I have not done any division by levels.

How often should I train presses?

Once a week. More info at page 25.

How many attempts and repetitions should I do both in the attempts and base.

For the attempts do minimum 3 tries per exercise or until you cannot perform it anymore with a good technique.

For the base try working with all the exercises by using the 80 percent rule that I explained.

How much rest do I need between the attempts?

As much as it allows you to perfectly execute the elements. Around 2-4 minutes is normal.

If you have any other questions regarding the program, feel free to ask me.

■ Conclusion

This is my way of training and performing those skills. It is not the only approach and for sure there are other ways. We all are different that is why some exercise may have different effect on different people. The idea of this e-book is to show you my methods so you can implement the ones that work for you in your training. Take all in info from this e-book and keep experimenting with yourself. And remember, never rush and you will have a smooth, steady and consistent progress with lack of injuries. Wish you a good luck!

Equipment used in the program

If you want to get the products I used in the program you have a chance for **10% discount** by using my promo codes.

The discount is available for all the products of the 2 big leaders - **Pullup-dip** and **Gornation**. Those brands have proven themselves for providing the best professional high quality calisthenics equipment.

1 Pullup-dip

Wooden Parallettes

In this e-book the brand is represented by the wooden parallettes.

The specially developed ergonomic wooden handle protects your wrists and offers you a perfect grip during planche performance. The feet are made of high-quality steel, including anti-slip pads, which ensures a safe and firm footing with every exercise.



Pullup-dip also offers a big variety of calisthenics equipment
Use **"KAMENOV10"** for **10% discount** on all their products
at www.pullup-dip.com

2 Gornation

Gornation is known with its high-quality clothes and calisthenic equipment. Use **“VKAMENOV”** for **10% discount** on all their products at www.gornation.com
In this e-book they are represented by the resistance bands and the clothes I wear

